2.6

Look East: '*Mingala Bar Khimbya*'

I was nominated for the Higher Command (HC) in February 2003 while still in command of 2 RR. After handing over command to Col B Yadav in June, we proceeded by road to Delhi, via Jammu and Dehradun. Veena and the girls had come for the summer holidays, so we all drove down together in a civil car. The drive from Srinagar was out of the world. The countryside was picturesque, of course, but the sheer magnificence of range after range after range of mountains that make up the Himalayas was humbling. It made one realize how insignificant we are in the overall scheme of things. After an overnight halt at Jammu, we proceeded to Dehradun, where we were to stay with Maj Gen Ashok Kapur, who was then the deputy commandant of the Indian Military Academy. As it so happened, the passing-out parade (POP) for the spring term 2003 was scheduled for the next day, so we witnessed the parade as the special guests of the deputy commandant. Isha and Amala got to see from where I had been commissioned more than two decades earlier. We did not tarry long at Dehradun but left soon after the parade, as I wanted to reach Delhi before nightfall.

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